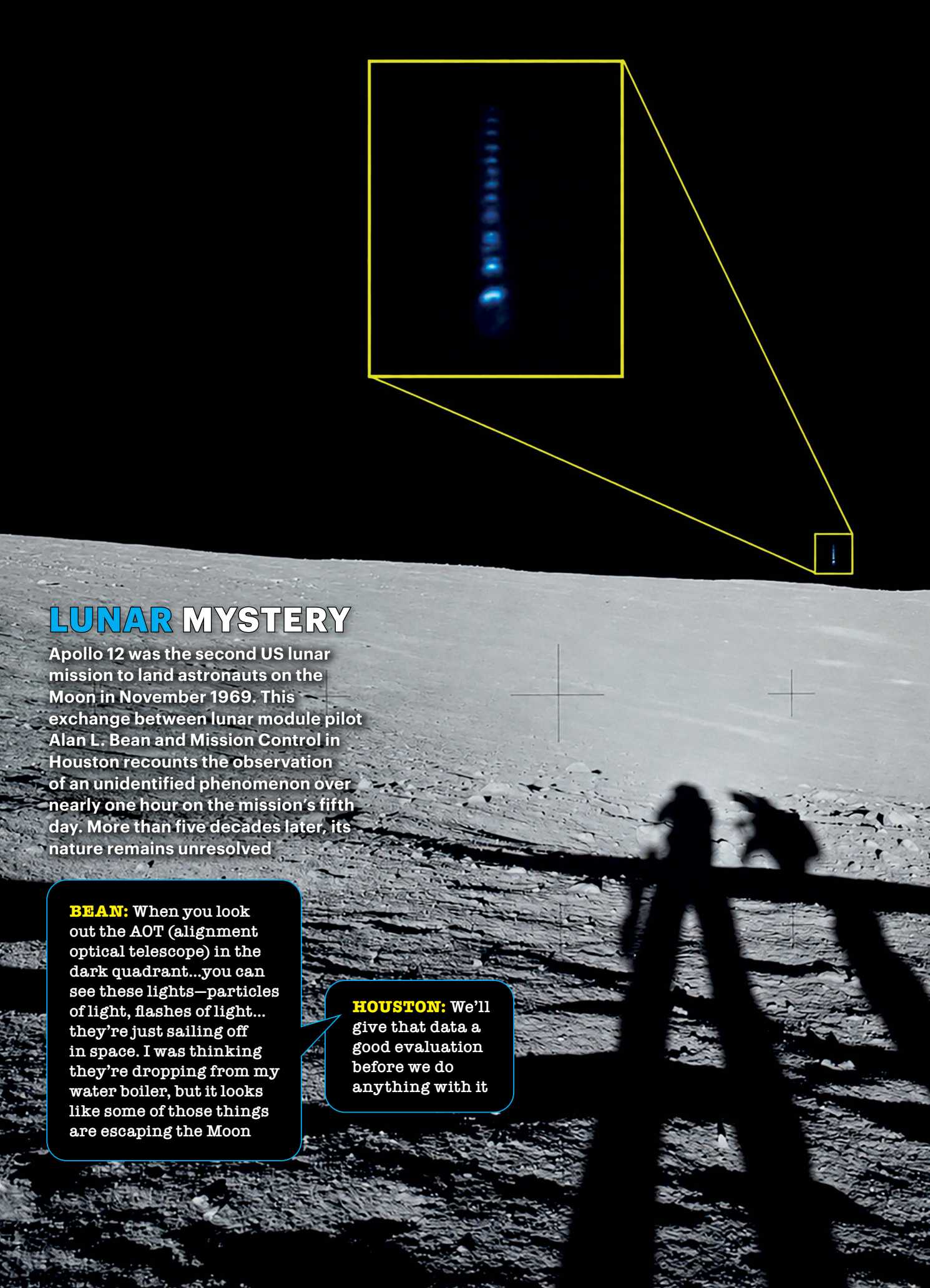


LUNAR MYSTERY

Apollo 12 was the second US lunar mission to land astronauts on the Moon in November 1969. This exchange between lunar module pilot Alan L. Bean and Mission Control in Houston recounts the observation of an unidentified phenomenon over nearly one hour on the mission's fifth day. More than five decades later, its nature remains unresolved

BEAN: When you look out the AOT (alignment optical telescope) in the dark quadrant...you can see these lights—particles of light, flashes of light... they're just sailing off in space. I was thinking they're dropping from my water boiler, but it looks like some of those things are escaping the Moon

HOUSTON: We'll give that data a good evaluation before we do anything with it